



A solid entry point for beginners to the series

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Let me get one thing out of the way right away, I haven't played any of the previous F1 games, so I went into F1 2021 with it being my first F1 game. The F1 games are normally known to be pretty hard, attempting to simulate what it would actually be like to be in the cockpit of an F1 car. With F1 2021, while you can certainly enjoy the complete F1 experience, you can tone it all down making it much more accessible to newcomers to the series. That being said, the latest title from Codemasters' F1 series could very well be considered a good entry point into the series. Let's get into the review.

Braking Point - The Story

F1 2021 sees the introduction of a story mode to the series for the first time ever. Well a proper story mode, there was an attempt in 2019, but

this is definitely a lot more fleshed out. Depending on how good you are at the game, the story mode will last around 6 hours. Dubbed Braking Point, the story mode sees us filling the shoes (and perspectives) of two drivers, Aiden Jackson and Casper Akkerman, both at very different points in their careers, with Aiden Jackson being brand new on the scene, and Casper Akkerman being a veteran beyond his prime. Both drivers are competing for the same team, but early in the story we see some drama develop between the two due to events that take place in a race. Enter Devon Butler, who some might recognise if they played F1 2019, but this is basically the antagonist in the story, who's more than happy to add fuel to the fire between Aiden and Casper. Codemasters have tried to bring the drama of real F1 into the game with

Braking Point, and while the plot is fairly predictable, it's a welcome addition to the game.

The story is also a great way for new players to experience the F1 series; during the course of the story you'll be introduced to different aspects of the game, or learn the ropes, so to speak. The story also isn't as simple as "win this race", but takes a different approach, with cinematics taking place in the middle of races as you fulfil objectives, which was nice. The game definitely has a difficulty curve, but stick with it and you'll get there.

Gameplay

Coming to the gameplay, like we mentioned earlier, you can tone down the difficulty aspect to an almost casual level in F1 2021. This doesn't mean that it's braindead now and you just need to hold down